

**School Committee Meeting
Monday, December 7, 2020
6:00PM via Zoom
Notes**

6:06 pm 7 present 0 absent

Mayor Breanna Lungo-Koehn, Paul Ruseau, Paulette Van der Kloot, Melanie Melanie McLaughlin, Mea Mustone, Kathy Kreatz and Jenny Graham all present

Motion to Approval of Minutes of 11.16.2020 Minutes

Motion of approval Paulette Van der Kloot Kathy Kreatz

Roll: 7 yes

Approval Bills

Motion to approve: Kathy Kreatz; seconded by Jenny Graham 7 affirmative 0 negative

Report of secretary

None

Communications Subcommittee:

Approval of minutes 11.10.2020 Jenny Graham

11.10.2020: Kindergarten process discussed. Added to the minutes. Looked at practices in neighboring districts at the timeline for Kindergarten open houses/registration. Charter school process starts as early as Jan 4 so the subcommittee looked at options for starting the process earlier. Now that online registration is up and running, we can think about starting the process earlier. Community members joined the meeting. Talked about methods of reaching families. Spoke of working with City hall about best ways to begin outreach and outbound tactics earlier. Spoke of understanding the process and listening to feedback from the community. In summary, revisions to timeline. Family Mailing then videos in december, outlining the registration process so that we reach families officially rather than through social media. Talked about reaching out in December to MFN and local preschools. Spoke of virtual cross school tours in January. Talked about tour nights being TBD for this year due to COVID but on a post pandemic wish list to provide structured methods of exposure for families. Registration will be opened in January online. Bridges to Kindergarten to be held in February. Typical visit days in May. Screenings in September. Intentionally outbounding information to prospective families. Encouraging registration to get going.

Motion to approve made by Melanie Melanie McLaughlin seconded by Paulette Van der Kloot

Roll call: 7 affirmative 0 negative. Minutes approved

12.1.2020: Meeting speaking about technology and structures in place to enable communication with families. Spoke of various systems the district uses and the history of use. Plans upcoming for MPS to make a selection for a communication vehicle. Dr. Cushing: it was on the roadmap for last summer and unfortunately delayed due to COVID. It will be returned to the docket next summer to make the transition. Members of PTO joined the meeting and

expressed requirements/needs for their communication campaigns. However we pursue a new system, we could include their needs. Desire on many people's part, use of a new system should not require the principal to manage the process. There should be rules of engagement to allow members of these groups to use the platform to communicate with their respective communities. Spoke about teacher communication platforms (dojo, etc.) and how this can change from year to year. Security and consistency are issues to be addressed. Group would like to gauge how both teachers and parents feel about these platforms.

Motion to approve minutes: Kathy Kreatz; seconded by Melanie McLaughlin
7 affirmative, minutes are approved

11.19.2020 Behavioral Health and SPED Subcommittee - Melanie McLaughlin

Stacey Shulman and Joan Bowen and members of the community are regular attendees. Trauma is the chosen topic of the Behavioral Health subcommittee. In the research phase of getting resources together for trauma informed schools. Goal in April of this year to present items to the School Committee. Mindfulness and best practices in trauma informed schools is a priority of Stacey Shulman.

Building friendships is a priority of the SPED School Committee. Morning, afternoon and athletic programs are explored. The Friendship toolkit from ARC of Massachusetts has been presented. The Best Buddies program is being talked about. Looking to build a volunteer base for students with disabilities in recreation settings. Siblings of students with disabilities also need support but also provide a potential source of support. Next meeting will be Dec. 17 from 5 to 6:30.

Motion to approve minutes made by Paul Ruseau then seconded by Paulette Van der Kloot
6:26

7 affirmative 0 negative minutes approved.

Communication Subcommittee Meeting: 11.18.2020

Paulette Van der Kloot: there were two presentations during the meeting: Medford Sepac as well as Joan Bowen and Suzannah Campbell (disability awareness in the classroom). Suzannah Campbell will be providing this program again this year via zoom. History of Disabilities in the US, legislation, ableism, disability etiquette, unique needs of students with various disabilities, breaking down stereotypes. Universal design, anti ableism in curriculum. Next steps are to recruit teachers for PD, and volunteers to implement this disability awareness curriculum. Not a one and done should be embedded in everyday instruction. Concept and awareness should be present ongoing. Last year 48 teachers took the course, hopefully as many this time. End result curriculum units to be shared amongst staff. Conversation about pre purchased curriculum vs. designing our own curriculum. Starting from Pilot and growing from there. Report and update to be provided at the end of the year with numbers of teachers who took the course this year. Lastly, the next meeting is December 10, looking at the Math Curriculum. Thanks to Tonya Sullivan and Alex Lauric of SEPAC and Suzannah Campbell and Joan Bowen

Motion to approve: Melanie McLaughlin Kathy Kreatz: roll call: seven affirmative, 0 negative paper passes.

Colin Bailey Student representative on the call.

COW: Special School Committee Meeting: 11.24.2020 School Metrics Meeting:

Motion to approve: Kathy Kreatz, Paulette Van der Kloot

Seven affirmative zero negative. Minutes are approved

Community participation:

Paul Ruseau introduced two speakers:

JoAnn McKay: Court St. Medford: speaking on behalf of Roberts Elementary

Things are changing rapidly at the Roberts School. Letter out of concern. Recent rise of cases at the Roberts. Currently 8 teachers, 4 paras, and 3 support staff in quarantine. Some are positive cases. We are unsure how we can sustain education at this time. Cohorts are exposed to various people. Support staff anxious about possible exposure. Numbers rising at a rate that is greatly alarming causing distress. In order for us to continue in this manner, we do not feel safe. We ask that the Roberts move into the remote plan for the current time to keep us safe.

Ms. Charlene Douglas, MTA President: shout out to the admin staff for the testing and all the work that they have been doing to get back in school. That being said, I want to speak on behalf of the membership[as MTA president concerned about uptick in cases. Both the Brooks and Roberts were both severely impacted today by rise in covid cases. The number of students positive at Roberts is 6. 5 positive students at Brooks at this time. Concerned about the health of students, staff and teachers at this time. Increased risk when asking people to provide support. There have been 295 cases in the last 7 days. We understand that it is best to teach in person but due to high risk as well as justified concern of staff, we strongly believe we should be remote until after winter break. Not an easy statement but we are frightened and scared and we have teachers coming down every day.

Paulette Van der Kloot: I am not going to address right now as reports are coming.

Paul Ruseau: no more emails right now.

Melanie McLaughlin

Thanks to Charlene. Thanks to Charlene and Ms. McKay. We will circle back?

Paulette Van der Kloot: Yes

Report of the Superintendent

Dr. Marice Edouard-Vincent: Thanks to Ms. McKay and Ms. Charlene Douglas. Hope after today's report, we can provide peace of mind.

Welcome to school representatives: David Mei MVTBS Business Mktg. and Colin Bailey MHS

Spoke of observance of Pearl Harbor;

The MHS Band was supposed to be in Honolulu this week. Due to virus, no travel

Disappointment to band students. Sorry this opportunity couldn't happen. Tree and wreath sale for band in Medford High parking lot this past weekend and this coming weekend. PTOs are doing fundraisers for the Holidays. Pampered Chef and TX roadhouse. Crew team raffle - gift card every month of January. Brooks PTO silent PTO this week. Columbus PTO seeking gift card donations for their community.

COVID cases rising in Medford and throughout the state. We need to remain vigilant. Divided we will fall. This past week, student covid testing began. PCR test with high accuracy rate. Same test as staff. Encouraging families to sign consent forms to have 100% participation for all students. Thankful to all school nurses overseeing this program. Thanks to all the staff and medford Fire department who have helped with this process. All hands are needed on deck and people are jumping in. Thursday, December 10, seniors are coming back to the HS. Thanks to the seniors who have shown patience as they waited for the HVAC improvements.

Given the risk of older students, free COVID testing for seniors before they arrive. Cohort C will be tested tomorrow between 3pm and 6pm Tuesday, Dec. 8

Cohort B: testing Friday Dec. 11; 3 pm and 6 pm

Thanks to Neighborhood Kitchen and West Medford Community Center for their collaboration in providing over a hundred thanksgiving meals

Survey from principal requesting feedback about educational experience due back tomorrow.

Students at McGlynn worked with Irobot on the project. The Attorney General's office spoke with students about internet safety.

In this season of giving, mfn is looking for help from the community. Adopt a family and donate a gift card. Please contact Marie Cassidy. Unable to fundraise during this pandemic.

Appreciate any support you can provide to them.

Girl Scouts - please visit school blog to order

School supply drive: collection at

7:00PM; letter from person appreciates admin listening to science and looking to get students back in school. thankful students return on Thursday

Melanie McLaughlin: Is there a robocall about testing and return? What happens if students don't test?

Superintendent Marice Edouard-Vincent: Mr. D'allava will get these calls out tonite and tomorrow. He has been communicating frequently. Calls will go out about Friday as well. Goal is 100%. Forms need to come in. Consent forms need to be completed. Not the painful test. Seniors can self administer this very accurate test. By Wednesday, we will get the results from Tuesday testing.

Melanie McLaughlin: can you please let SC know of the participation rate. What about transportation problems for students? I am sure there are volunteers who would help. Can the robocall reflect this need?

Superintendent Marice Edouard-Vincent: I know Mr. D'allava has been sending communications to let students know. I am not sure of the numbers in need with transportation. It is critically important for seniors to try their best to come to school for testing. Please reach out to Mr. D'alleva if you need help.

Melanie McLaughlin: May I respectfully ask that this be included in the robocall?

Superintendent Marice Edouard-Vincent: OK

Paul Ruseau: Another email
Can we get an update for other grades for the high school?

Superintendent Marice Edouard-Vincent: Official dates for the other grades at the high school? In January, 9, 10 and 11 will be staggered in. Seniors, the 10th and 14th. We have not disclosed what the dates are but it would be early January for 11th and then 10th and 9th grades. Communications will follow as space is available.

7:09 COVID 19 Report: Toni Wray (MOC not here tonight)
Averaging 51 positive cases a day. 1.42 positivity rate. Increasing alongside activity in the state. Community transmission not in schools. Due to Thanksgiving activities. Acknowledging the firefighters. Dr. Patrick Sabia, School Physician, and the school nurses. At school moving is tested twice a week for staff, once a week for students. We are offering layers of protection for students in staff. Alpha Med Screening, testing, desk screens, social distancing at 6 feet, and contact tracing. Since Sept. no in school transmission through contact tracing.

Mayor Lungo-Koehn: Thank you Ms. Wray.

Paul Ruseau: thank you for the report. How many close contacts we have identified for each case.

Toni Wray: yes we do. I don't have it at my fingertips right now.

Paul Ruseau: That would be good to have. Are any of our positives having a close contact count of zero?

Toni Wray: Yes. that speaks to the mitigation efforts teachers are providing in the classroom. Some teachers are using a pointer in order to maintain the distance so they can maintain the six feet.

Paul Ruseau: Can we get the numbers by grade level? Thinking K students could not have zero contacts? I would like to know more about the ones designated as zero. I am surprised there could be zero for anyone. For cohort A, these students mix with cohorts B and C so are we contact tracing into B and C as well.

Toni Wray: Yes into specials as well

Paul Ruseau: as for protocols on cleaning: are we cleaning between classes entering into a room?

Toni Wray: Yes supplies are in each classroom. Handwashing is encouraged as well as hand sanitizer has been added to the buildings.

Dave Murphy: Different rounds of sanitation are being done in between classes. There are cases at secondary level when the full fogging cannot be done between classes. Frequency of fogging is being adhered to although in certain cases, there is not enough time for the fog substance to settle in when students need to enter the room. The window of time can be narrow.

Mayor Lungo-Koehn: Toni, the teachers spoke earlier being nervous. Can you speak to the contact tracing that happened over the weekend to give some reassurance?

Toni Wray: Contact tracing around 7 positive cases. Done by four different nurses in addition to myself. Interviews take time. Upon receiving information, I shared data with the admin, mayor and discussed health metrics and how data fit into the metrics. All options were explored. Families notified early in the day by School nurses.

Kathy Kreatz: Thank you. Question, when you do the contact tracing, does it include recess?

Toni Wray: we ask teachers about the activities of the classroom. Recess poses a different situation since they are outside. We follow up with whoever the student is hanging out with.

Kathy Kreatz: Brief messages received. Could you define what a close contact is?

Toni Wray: Someone who has cared for a COVID positive person or within 6 feet for over 15 minutes

Paulette Van der Kloot: I want to make sure I understand the teacher statement. Only one in school transmission?

Toni Wray: Yes only one. Others were community transmission. Other teachers who are out on quarantine were determined to be close contacts to a positive case either student or staff member. Some cases are asymptomatic and coming to work and being picked up by school testing. We are getting them before they feel symptoms.

Paulette Van der Kloot: All of us feel this anxiety right now as we see numbers rise in MA and the rest of the country.

Toni Wray: When we quarantine people, we are not seeing cases appear when they are out.

Paulette Van der Kloot: I understand that quarantine is an important piece of the prevention methodology. Is there any change in the data that necessitates a change in what we are doing.

Toni Wray: We have had to close a classroom but schools are safe. People disobeyed CDC recommendations and we are seeing the results of that activity now.

Paulette Van der Kloot: When we see the number of staff out on quarantine, do we have enough coverage?(To Superintendent Marice Edouard-Vincent). at the roberts right now, are we able to cover right now? Is it working?

Superintendent Marice Edouard-Vincent: The number of staff out at Roberts is high but we have moved teachers in supplemental roles to assist. There is a lot of management that is happening. When I spoke with the principal today, they did have alternative coverage, there is an additional level of stress due to normal personal days or sick days of staff. We are paying attention to what roles are being affected. Significant amount of adults are not in the building today but should be higher tomorrow. There are 18 general education classrooms and 5 specialized classrooms. Of those 23, 5 homeroom based teachers that were not in. We would love to see zero but we are working with that number. We look at the structure and where are the homerooms? If an art teacher isn't in, the students can still participate in the instructional day. We look at all those factors and if the school can run. At that point, we will communicate with SC and the school community to look at other options.

Kathy Kreatz: One more?: If a person thinks they were a close contact but they were not contacted, what should they do?

Mayor: Call the School nurse, Ms. Wray or Ms. O'Connor. Let's put this in perspective a little bit: the positive thing we have in Medford, we have been providing testing so we can catch these cases as soon as we can. This could not be possible without the team of the schools and the board of health and working with Broad Institute. 22 more staff needed each Tuesday or Friday to make this happen. Proud that we could make this happen. Thank you Toni.

Toni Wray: We recently signed an agreement with Northeastern university who will provide 24 student nurses to help. We will be a clinical sight for them. Very exciting.

David Murphy: We cannot adequately express gratitude to the Tufts community for their making this happen for Medford Public Schools. Valuable time that has made this program a success so far.

Jenny Graham: thank you to everyone making this testing available. It is important to id cases as fast as we can to contain the spread. We hope we can extend into January and how we find a way to do that. Section three has not been updated yet. There are differences in people who have tested positive and those who have been quarantined. I would like to ask that the close contact number be on the spreadsheet in the school specific conditions. The spreadsheet should be posted on a weekly basis on our website. If we can get to that level of specificity it would be helpful. Hearing lots of numbers. Difficult to rationalize all of that as it is spoken. Information to be publicly available.

Toni Wray: thank you Jenny. The quarantine list will not reflect numbers just in school; majority are quarantined due to their own household or community.

Jenny Graham; I am more interested in close contact numbers within the school environment.

Toni Wray: that is a whole different piece of information.

Jenny Graham: People contact me saying their kids are happy going to school but as parents looking for data to make their own decisions. I couldn't point them anywhere.

David Murphy: I don't know that there is a need for a motion. We want to publish as much information as possible. The rapidity that this data is coming in and changing and the limitations on district capacity poses challenges. No hesitancy on our point but the priority is response and communication to those affected. Coverage then execution of the testing program puts us in a position. The data will never be all families want it to be. The activity is constant. We will publish all we have but if you are a close contact, then you will be contacted by BOH or a representative of health services. Data on the website useful for a macro not micro vantage point.

7:45: Jenny Graham: Can we not publish two times a week for each cohort? Are we that thin as a district that we cannot provide the support needed? I would like to see us publish twice a week because the district will get bogged down by independent inquiries. That is taxing as well. When can they expect to see this stuff?

David Murphy: Totally reasonable point. We all want to publish the information but we want to publish it in a reliable fashion. The more data we need to collect, the more difficult. I feel we need to collaborate as a team to figure out how often we can do this. The reason we are building our testing muscle, the better it will be. Once Northeastern is on board, that might be more doable but best information is provided by the board of health. We have to look at other systems at the building level. School nurses always have time to respond to families about safety. Nothing will replace those phone calls.

Jenny Graham: If we are going to stick with once a week. Can it happen on Monday since it is being presented every other Monday anyway? Multiple uses and the testing that comes in from Friday that is reasonable. We do need to commit to testing on a weekly basis.

David Murphy: I see that Monday would be advantageous. We will discuss this with our team to see how we can revise these systems.

Suzanne Galusi: Concern about close contact information because in many schools, the quarantines have nothing to do with Medford Public Schools. I am concerned that looking at these numbers will cause more worry in parents. The coverage issue is the domino effect.

Mayor Lungo-Koehn: Maybe Admin can meet to determine the best way to report and let us know by Monday?

Paul Ruseau: The elephant in the room is trust in response to Suzanne Galusi. Can the families trust us? We trusted the state and they moved the goalpost. We don't want to be moving the goalpost on contact tracing as well? I want evidence that the trust is deserved. There is data that can be used. State and federal officials have fallen flat. Every school employee is part of the government. I want to point that out.

7:55pm

Mayor Lungo-Koehn: I trust Ms. Wray and her team. I would say so if I didn't.

Ms. Willard; can we get a response on Charlene Douglas or JoAnn McKay's letters? There was a request to go remote and this wasn't discussed. Teachers are looking for reassurance. Teachers are nervous about the situation. We are seeing extremely high cases. Students were not tested until last week. I am wondering if someone can respond.

Superintendent Marice Edouard-Vincent: I am sorry you feel this way. We are providing testing. I spoke with the principal of the Roberts and we looked at the numbers of quarantined staff. Not all because of school exposure. Could be at home or within the respective community. 5 homeroom teachers are quarantined at Roberts. It is a moving schedule. As administrators, we are looking at the entire school. We are not looking at 23 homerooms without teachers. We are responding to each situation as they arise. Consistency, Equity and safety are our highest priorities. With the information from contact tracing we have identified staff that need to be quarantined. That is our response right now. IF the data significantly shifts, we will make a different decision at that time. Two teachers are scheduled to return this week. Principal says the school can continue to function. If the results on Wednesday, we will be the first to communicate that out. I don't feel there is anything we can do in addition at this time. I am grateful that our district is in a position to provide testing. All departments are tested. We are doing everything we can do.

Gary Klein: Father of MHS student and two recent graduates. Thanks to the team for all the hard work. Speaking favorably about cautious approaches to students returning to the high school. Looks like there have been 500 cases since Thanksgiving. Possibly 1500 cases before Christmas. Disheartening since we are close to the vaccine at this point. Concerned that

schools will contribute to the high numbers. Higher risk of transmission at the high school level. Let's be patient and cautious before returning more students.

Paul Ruseau: 3 more emails to read

Sharon Hays: Can you clarify when parent surveys are due?

Suzanne Galusi: Due next Tuesday, December 15.

Jamie Taylor: Parents do not need to have students tested? Honor system not working. Students came to school on Monday after being out of state. If 100% of the students are not tested, how can we say the schools are safe?

David Murphy: Of the 7 or 8 positives, there were 1300 tests administered. Even with the operation challenges, switching to remote in pockets is better than switching a whole school. We have to pay attention to risk factors of older students but we cannot say that this hasn't worked.

Toni Wray: Quarantine protocols: Families can decide not to test and keep students home for 14 days. If you test a student at day 8 and tests negative, they can return on day 11. Mass guidelines are coming soon about changes in quarantine timelines. Testing gets a student back into school sooner.

Paul Ruseau: One more email:

Leticia Rocha: as Ms. Douglas and Ms. Kay mentioned, what is the capacity for contact tracing when it comes to schools?

Mayor Lungo-Koehn: City well equipped but we have been sending some cases to Mass CTC.

Toni Wray: We handle the school cases but collaborate with the Board of Health.

Peter Cushing: BOH and school nurses are working 24/7 and I believe we need to give a round of applause to this team.

Paul Ruseau: Leticia Rocha: What is the current Medford Positivity rate without tufts?

Mayor Lungo-Koehn: Tufts affects our numbers but not as much as you would think?

Paul Ruseau: Leticia Rocha: according to DESE Records, ____ have occurred in the schools? What is stopping school transmission from happening as it did in Framingham? Case rate of HS is three times that of Elementary students.

Toni Wray: Minimal districts across the state are doing testing. We minimize the number of close contacts by removing cases early from our buildings.

Paul Ruseau: Notification today that MCAS is postponed.

Peter Cushing: Postponement for Juniors who need to be tested to get their diploma. The testing was dictated by DESE. Four week window had been provided. Self corrected: notified today that the testing is postponed.

Paul Ruseau: question about school closures

David Murphy: As a plan was developed, there is a schedule and structure in place to support learning if switch to remote becomes necessary.

Jessica (public): Speaking about testing for students in quarantine. Son was quarantined in October. 14 days was mandatory back then.

Mayor: Yes this was the old standard. It has changed and may change again this week.

8:22: Toni Wray: Abbot Binax testing report

Medford will be a pilot district for this rapid testing initiative with the state. See slides.

Tests can be read in 15 minutes on site in the nurse's office. Students testing positive can be prompt faster response and start of contact tracing. Depending on these test results, the students may return to school faster. For students with minimal symptoms, we could administer the test for them. Positive - response; negative- return to class.

Training provided by the state. Consent forms will need to be completed. State providing the consent forms. Final piece is required to report to DPH.

Paul Ruseau: question about presumptive positives being sent to pediatricians.

Toni Wray: Negative testing students will be sent home and then sent to the pediatrician (may be strep throat or other sickness).

Paul Ruseau: If they get a positive, will we do a PCR test?

Toni Wray: No. we will treat them as a positive.

8:28 Report on Responsive Classroom: Suzanne Galusi and Stacey Shulman

Suzanne Galusi:

Program at the elementary school level: when closure hit in march, I was principal of Brooks. Social and Emotional wellbeing was key. Maintaining connection was most important. Brooks is a responsive classroom school. Maintaining virtual morning meeting time and ensured kids stayed connected.

Stacey Schulman: Timeline fo RC Implementation PD through Cares grant funding

Suzanne Galusi: Responsive Classroom is an approach PDIS and zones of regulation can work with SC

Belief that students learn best with development of social and emotional skills.

Many of components: morning meeting; rules creation to give voice to students, interactive modelling,
Slide Show on Responsive Classroom

Joan Bowen's report on Updated Bullying Prevention Plan

8:51: Melanie McLaughlin: Is there an opportunity to do a single page sheet, one for staff, one for students and one for families to better understand this report? A summary sheet for each constituency would be helpful.

Joan Bowen: Yes there is a lot in the 34 pages.

Melanie McLaughlin: Notation for presentation plan on bullying for Parents on a regular basis?

Joan Bowen: Last one in April was on cybersafety. We will do a presentation for parents on each topic.

Melanie McLaughlin: maybe there can be a general presentation on rights, procedure? You put a lot into this report. Many seem like one off events. As we move forward, how do incorporate it into the curriculum? Not a question that is easily answered. Just putting it out there. Michigan Model: can you give us a bit on what that is?

Joan Bowen: training for mostly gym and health teachers talking about internet safety, relationship safety: certain topics taught at different grade levels.

Melanie McLaughlin: Are there specific aspects of Michigan Model that deal with bullying

Joan Bowen: Yes. Bullying is embedded.

Melanie McLaughlin: Page 21, item 2: Two or more incidences being reported
Is there always an incidence report? How does this move into an investigation report? Is there a flowchart?

Joan Bowen: We always recommend when the word bullying is used, the form is provided. Then it is determined what is the next step.

Peter Cushing: Whenever the word bullying is used, a person filling out a report should make a copy to date stamp it. That initial incident report is the start of the investigation. It may be a no find of bullying.

Melanie McLaughlin: Whether it is found to be bullying or not, there is evidence of the event. From the incident to investigation, who determines whether it is bullying?

Peter Cushing: Should be the principal

Melanie McLaughlin: on page 23, parents will be offered counseling as will aggressors. What is that? Is it a partnership with outside organizations?

Joan Bowen: School adjustment counselors for students. For parents, we could use community partners like Elliott. We would try to keep it in house to provide more continued support.

Melanie McLaughlin: Page 24, item 3A and 2A: Bullying is provided under criminal harassment under MGL: a link to this would be great.

Peter Cushing: The criminal harassment is the mechanism for law enforcement to get involved. Takes 3 incidences on the same person. That can be frustrating to prevent further events.

Melanie McLaughlin: The law is one manifestation of power but the school committee can change it to be fewer than three events.

Peter Cushing: it is in the statute. 3 Incidents.

9:10 PRS question Melanie McLaughlin
Is there a reason you didn't include Civil Rights?

Joan Bowen: the checklist DESE provided did not include Civil rights but I can look into it

Melanie McLaughlin: I thought this document was helpful but dense. I didn't see anything addressing if a student felt bullied by a staff member? Am I wrong?

Joan Bowen: I believe it is if a student is bullied by anyone.

Melanie McLaughlin: what is the process by which SC is notified of bullying incidents? Is there a process by which there is annual or bi-annual data provided.

Peter Cushing: Incident reports are confidential but some type per school per grade level could be possible. The principals have been informed that they need to use the forms and send them to central administration.

Melanie McLaughlin: I encourage that every school's handbook has a link to this full document. Many families are not aware that an incident report should be filed at the allegation level. This information should be pushed to them.

Joan Bowen: Yes this can be included in the summary sheet.

Melanie McLaughlin: Yes and included in the handbook and posted on the website.

Paulette Van der Kloot: Thanks for all the work on this comprehensive report. In the incident report, I don't see the date of the incident on it?

Peter Cushing: I can clarify or make the addition right now.

Paulette Van der Kloot: I am concerned that there is no timeline on notification of parents in there. I am not comfortable with approving this tonight. Normally it would go to rules and regulations for review.

Peter Cushing: I can offer a suggestion. Would we be able to approve it as is in addition to be sent to the rules committee?

Paulette Van der Kloot: That would be an unusual way of doing SC business.

Peter Cushing: I can work on the timelines in the interim. I want to give the investigator more space to work with and have no problem adding space to these forms.

Kathy Kreatz: A summary or checklist would be helpful. I would like to clarify does the definition of cyber bullying include social media sites?

Joan Bowen: Yes

Kathy Kreatz: I would be comfortable approving with recommended changes.

Jenny Graham: I would be fine with approving in the interim and sending to rules sub. There is mention of out of school suspension so that needs to be looked at. Some of the links were broken in the references section (MARRC). I have been thinking about the summary reporting that was referenced earlier about ways of reporting not using forms. Long review cycle for things that change rapidly. Reference in the document regarding MOA with Medford Police dept. Need to look at that in the RPE committee.

Melanie McLaughlin: I am good with approving and sending to RPE. I would like an additional link regarding manifestation of disability.

Joan Bowen: Sure

Paul Ruseau: Motion to approve and send to RPE meeting for review.

Melanie McLaughlin: Second

9:29 Roll: 7 affirmative, 0 negative, paper passes and moves to the RPE Subcommittee

New Business:

Snow Days in light of the altered model of educational delivery (copy from agenda)
Offered by Paul Ruseau

MASC said we should make a determination about snow days.

Superintendent Marice Edouard-Vincent: Having the opportunity to function remotely if necessary is wonderful but if we have a repeat of blizzard of 78 with a true state of emergency. If we are able to get parking lots plowed, we would get school in session. I will do my best to provide consistency and give students as much time in school. Each day that we declare as a snow day gets added on at the end of the school year. If we are able to avoid extending the year, I believe that would be better.

Paul Ruseau: In some districts they are saying there will be no snow days. Hopefully we won't have another snowmageddon like a couple of Februarys ago.

Kathy Kreatz: Do late starts affect the end of the school year?

Superintendent Marice Edouard-Vincent: Delays don't affect the school year. I would consider them for next school year. There is an order that the roads get plowed. If it is a storm where people are losing power, I would have to call a snow day. We need to consider the driving hazards that face our teachers in their drive to Medford. My preference is to continue with remote teaching but valid reasons would necessitate a snow day. Superintendents receive weather updates and I also consult with neighboring districts.

Resolution Offered by Jenny Graham: (include from agenda)

Important for us to do Superintendent Marice Edouard-Vincent's that we couldn't do last spring for the 2019-2020 school year. She is our only direct report so we need to hold up our end of her employment agreement and have a discussion about goals for the next school year.

Paulette Van der Kloot: First step is for Superintendent Marice Edouard-Vincent to do a self evaluation. Important to do this but it is a bit unfair to ask for it by Dec. 21. I propose the first meeting of January.

Kathy Kreatz: First step is self evaluation. Then a process of completing the eval over many COW meetings. I agree with giving more time. The committee has to determine the process of doing the evaluation per the MASC guidebook.

Mayor Lungo-Koehn: Superintendent Marice Edouard-Vincent what do you think is a good time frame?

Superintendent Marice Edouard-Vincent: I would request beginning to mid January extension. So much with going on with getting MHS up and running and launching the testing that would be helpful.

Paulette Van der Kloot: Could you send the guidelines from MESAC to us Kathy:

Kathy Kreatz: yes

Jenny Graham: What is the protocol to make sure that the steps are followed?

Kathy Kreatz: In past years, it was COW. All members want to be a part of that process. It is a big process.

Jenny Graham: I agree it is a big process and want to make sure we prioritize the process so we don't get to June with two reviews to write. It is unfair to delay it. I want to make sure we get caught up and also get the goal setting process in place.

Paulette Van der Kloot: We have been setting goals for her throughout this whole period: goals of inclusivity, getting kids back in school. It would be erroneous to think we haven't given direction to our superintendent. My recollection from other times is each of us individually fills out an evaluation and then we gather as a committee, discuss and prepare a collaborative document. Next step is to review what we are supposed to do, have the Super provide self evaluation by mid January.

Mayor Lungo-Koehn: I will schedule a COW as soon as we receive the self evaluation.

Jenny: What about the goals?

Mayor Lungo-Koehn: by end of January

Jenny: Supposed to quantifiable and data driven.

Paulette Van der Kloot:
Super has a major piece in setting up goals and quantifying them.

Mayor Lungo-Koehn:
Perhaps when you do your evaluation, perhaps you could bullet point your goals.

Superintendent Marice Edouard-Vincent: Yes. I can do that.

Kathy Kreatz: Citing MESC document, professional practice and student learning goals must be included. I know this was updated in December 2019. We haven't done the new process with the new goals yet.

Paul Ruseau: At the summer institute two summers ago, MESC had a session on the new method. Was a dramatic change from the past. They have changed the old system. We won't have to fill out the pages long document on this.

ROLL: Motion that Superintendent Marice Edouard-Vincent complete self evaluation on or before January 15th. COW by February 8th.

Point of Information: Melanie McLaughlin: I am not understanding what needs to be done by the 8th. In between those dates, we will have to do as many COW meetings as we can to discuss.

Motion for approval:

Jenny Graham: Melanie McLaughlin: Roll: 7 affirmative, 0 negative paper passes as amended.

Resolution:

Rates on usage of Alpha Med app and number of students being tested.

Offered by Jenny Graham

I would like to know how adopted the tools are that we have on hand like testing and Alpha Med as we head into spring about whether we can continue these things.

Seconded Paul Ruseau

ROLL: 7 affirmative, 0 negative paper passes as amended.

Proposed schedule of budget hearings to create the 2021/2022 no later than the first meeting of January.

Paul Ruseau: Seconded it.

Paulette Van der Kloot: I understand you want to start the process early (Jenny Graham) but we need to trust the superintendent and I don't feel we need to legislate it. If you are concerned about it, you should have conversations with her and not put it in a resolution. I would amend it to be the end of January.

Jenny Graham: The point of laying out a schedule is not about trust. It has nothing to do with trust. There are six people on the committee, numerous admin affected and a public who want to know what the budget will be. I didn't prescribe when the schedule will be.

Kathy Kreatz: I agree with Paulette Van der Kloot. Schedule comes out in February and meetings start in April typically. I want to vote for a schedule but we need to give more time. End of January would be better. Our administrators have not had any time off. Too much going on.

Kathy Kreatz seconded amendment. Jenny Graham agreed January 25th.

ROLL: 7 affirmative paper passes with amended date January 25th. 10:04

Ad Hoc report request on COVID expenses offered by member Paul Ruseau:

I had a brief conversation with Superintendent Marice Edouard-Vincent about this and I know it is not as simple as it sounds.

Seconded Jenny Graham;

Melanie McLaughlin: question, in addition to the self evaluation, budget schedule, we are asking the superintendent to provide us with yet another item in the middle of bringing in our students in the midst of a pandemic directly after the holidays?

Kathy Kreatz: I don't think it is achievable right now? As an ad hoc request report, she can determine how long it will take and how it will be done?

Paul Ruseau: I did use the ad hoc policy and form.

Paulette Van der Kloot: Will the superintendent report back to us at the next meeting and tell us when it can be done?

Superintendent Marice Edouard-Vincent: I will try to have it ready at the next meeting. I will make it a priority.

Paul Ruseau: If we need to plan for COVID next September, (children have not yet been tested with the immunization trials). Come this spring, the number of unknowns will be similar to last year. Let's suffer early to make corrections rather than at the last time.

Superintendent Marice Edouard-Vincent: I am optimistic that we can get the budget meetings schedule and have rich conversations ahead of the deadline. I agree with what you shared in that we don't know what will happen with the vaccine. We will do our due diligence to get you as many responses as possible due to COVID expenses. We will get you something substantive to respond to the specific questions you have.

Paul Ruseau: made motion Paulette Van der Kloot seconded it

Roll: 7 affirmative 0 negative paper passes (no due date)

Resolutions: condolences

Motion to adjourn: 10:14pm Melanie McLaughlin, Kathy Kreatz

ROLL: 7 affirmative 0 negative meeting is adjourned.